

THE BLACK PANTHER

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\$47 Million Damage Suit Trial Begins

ALL-WHITE JURY IN FRED HAMPTON MURDER CASE?



The families of slain Black Panther Party leaders FRED HAMPTON and MARK CLARK (inset) have to yet to receive justice for the execution-style murders which took place on December 4, 1969. A \$47 million suit filed in federal court against those responsible for this vicious FBI-police conspiracy faces a distinct probability of being tried by an all-White jury.

(Chicago, Ill.) - With five of the six federal court jurors swiftly selected, an all-White jury looms as the distinct probability in the \$47 million damage suit case arising from the infamous assassination of Illinois State Black Panther Party leaders Fred Hampton and Mark Clark.

Four White men and one White woman have already been seated as jurors in the long-delayed, heated trial, while five Blacks on the possible jury panel have been dismissed, two on peremptory challenges by attorneys representing the law enforcement officials responsible for the December 4, 1969, predawn police attack.

Plaintiffs in the case are seven former Black Panther Party members who survived the fusillade of over 100 bullets poured into the Westside apartment by the murdering police — four of whom were wounded in the assault — and the families of the two slain Party leaders.

The defendants are: the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI); the Chicago Police Department; former Cook County State's Attorney Edward Hanrahan, under whom the 14 raiding policemen worked as members of an elite "prosecutions" unit; three former Hanrahan assistants; and William O'Neal, a Judas FBI informer who infiltrated the Chapter.

The prospect of an all-White jury heightens the chances that biased, racist attitudes will tilt the scales so as to make even a semblance of justice impossible.

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